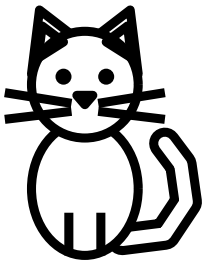
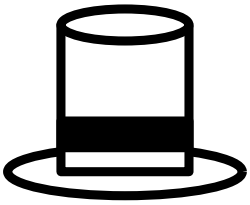
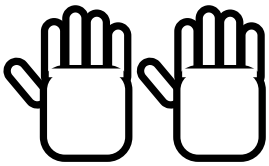
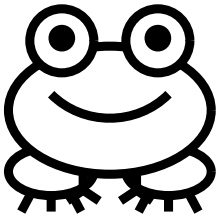
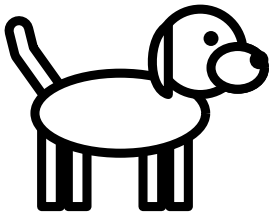
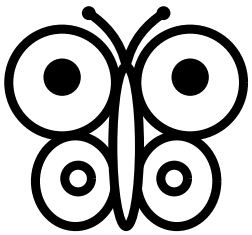
Rhyme and Syllables

Listening Games

Ages about 3 to 5 · Black and white · Free printable

Hear words that rhyme.

Clap the beats in words.

No reading needed: a grown-up says the words.

Note for grown-ups

What this teaches

Rhyming words sound the same at the end, like cat and hat. Syllables are the beats in a word: sun has one beat and ap-ple has two. Your child learns to hear both just by listening. There is nothing to read.

What comes next

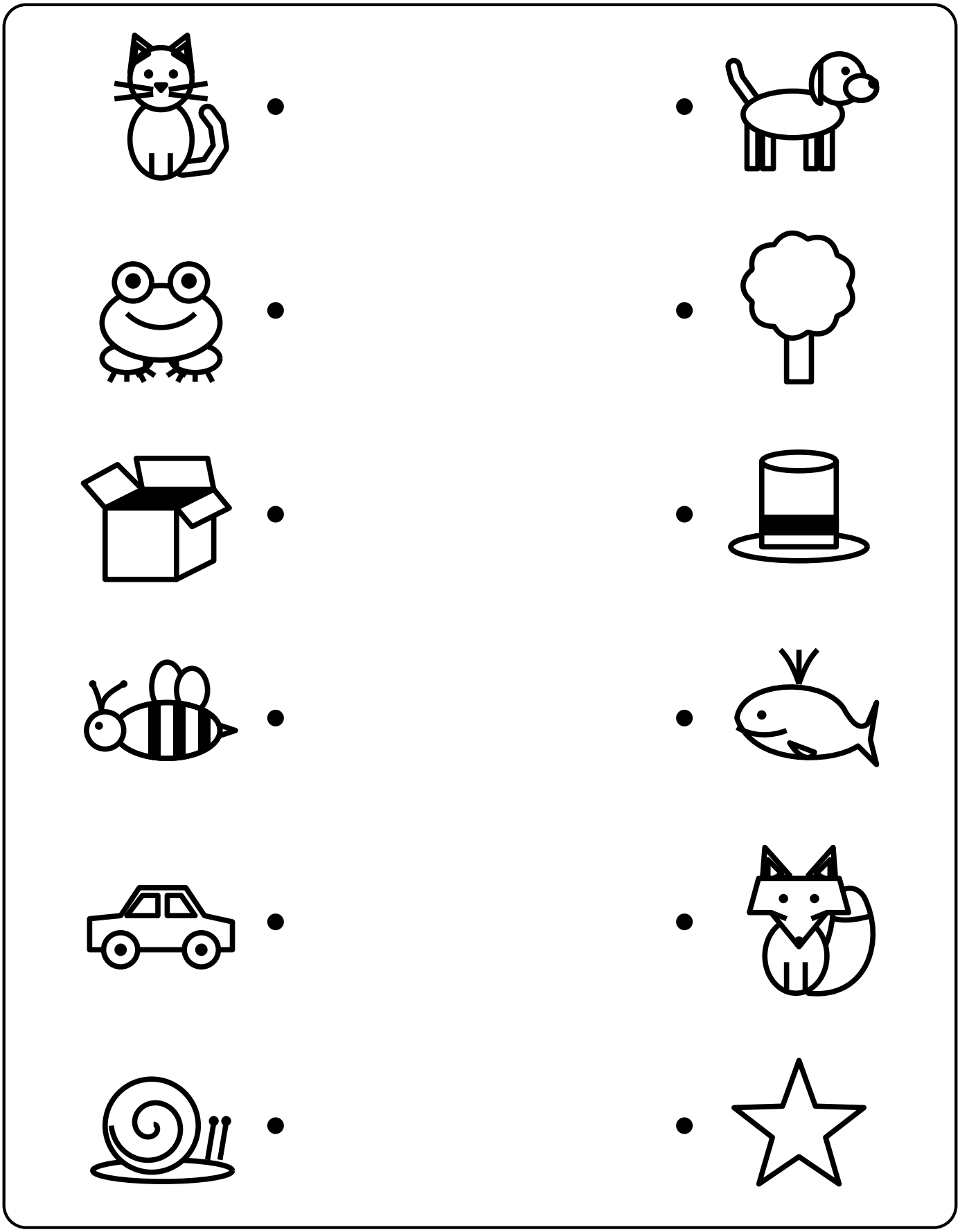
Make up silly rhymes together and clap the beats in family names, then move on to hearing the first sound in a word.

What you need

Your voice: say each picture's name aloud (the names are on the answer page) and clap once for each beat while your child copies you. Also a pencil, crayons and child-safe scissors.

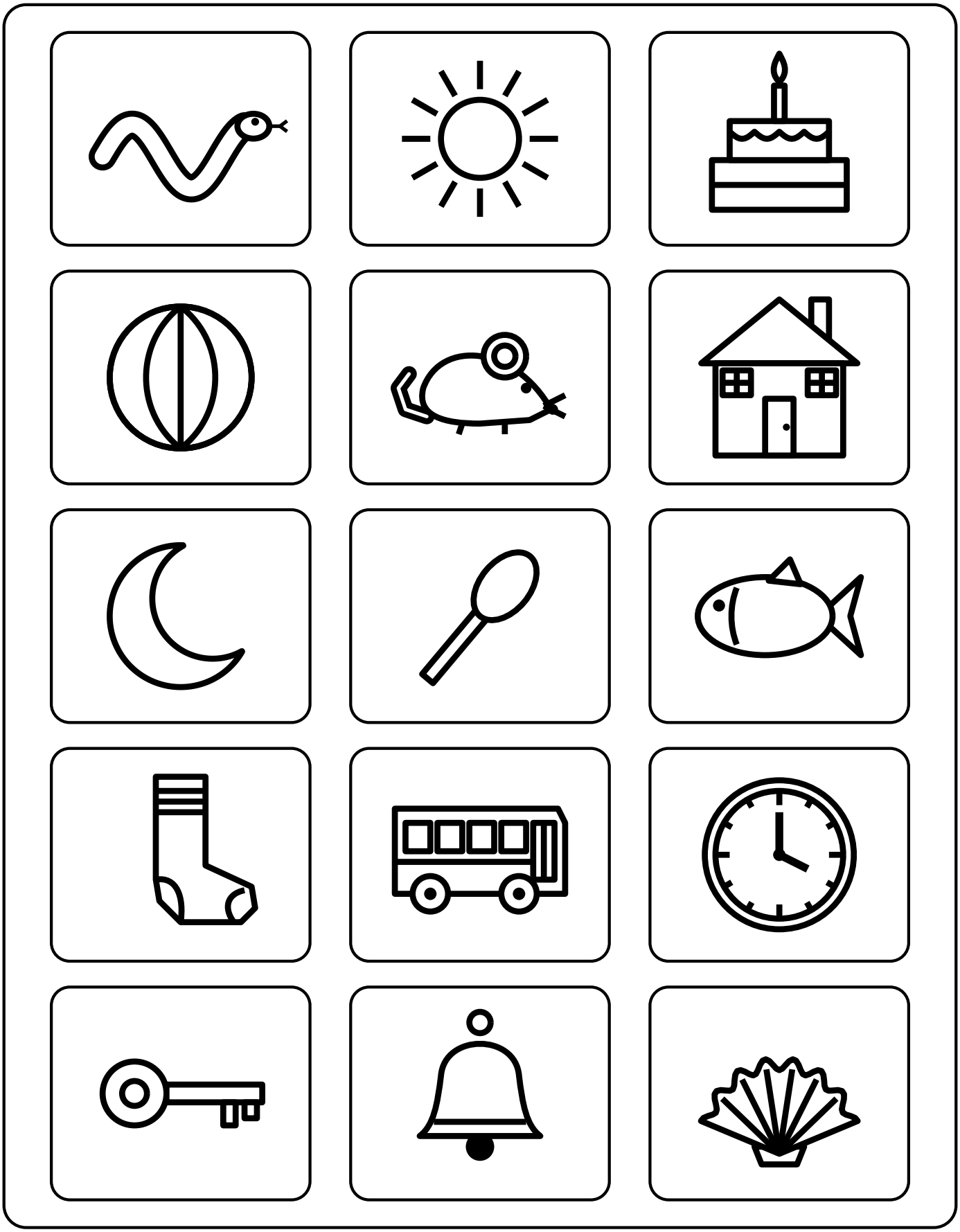
Rhyme match

Grown-up: say the name of every picture. Your child draws a line from each picture on the left to the picture on the right that rhymes with it.



Odd one out

Grown-up: say the three names in each row. Two of them rhyme. Your child circles the picture that does not rhyme.

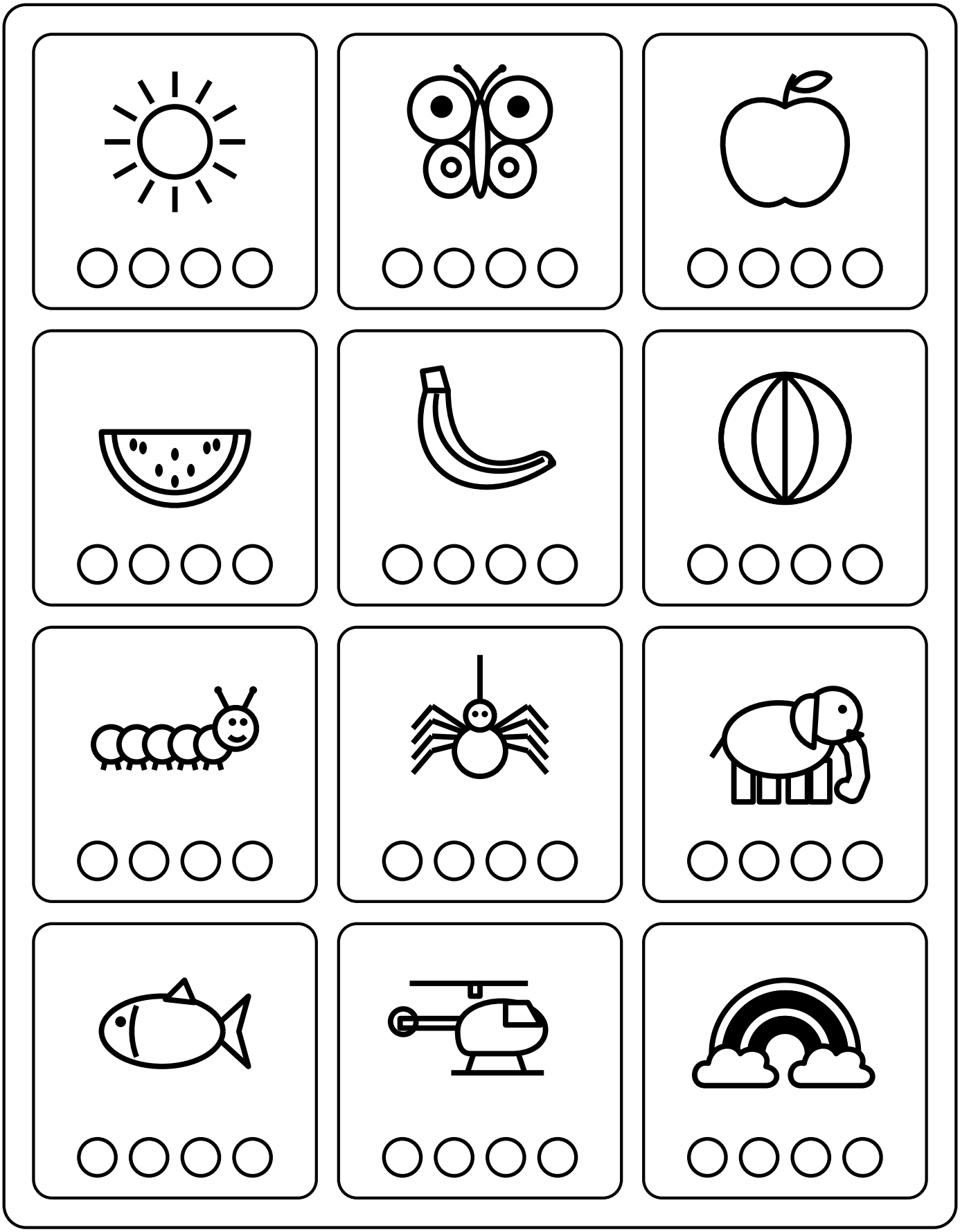


Rhyme cards

Grown-up: cut along the dashed lines. Play snap or a memory game: a pair is two pictures that rhyme. Say both names when you turn a card.

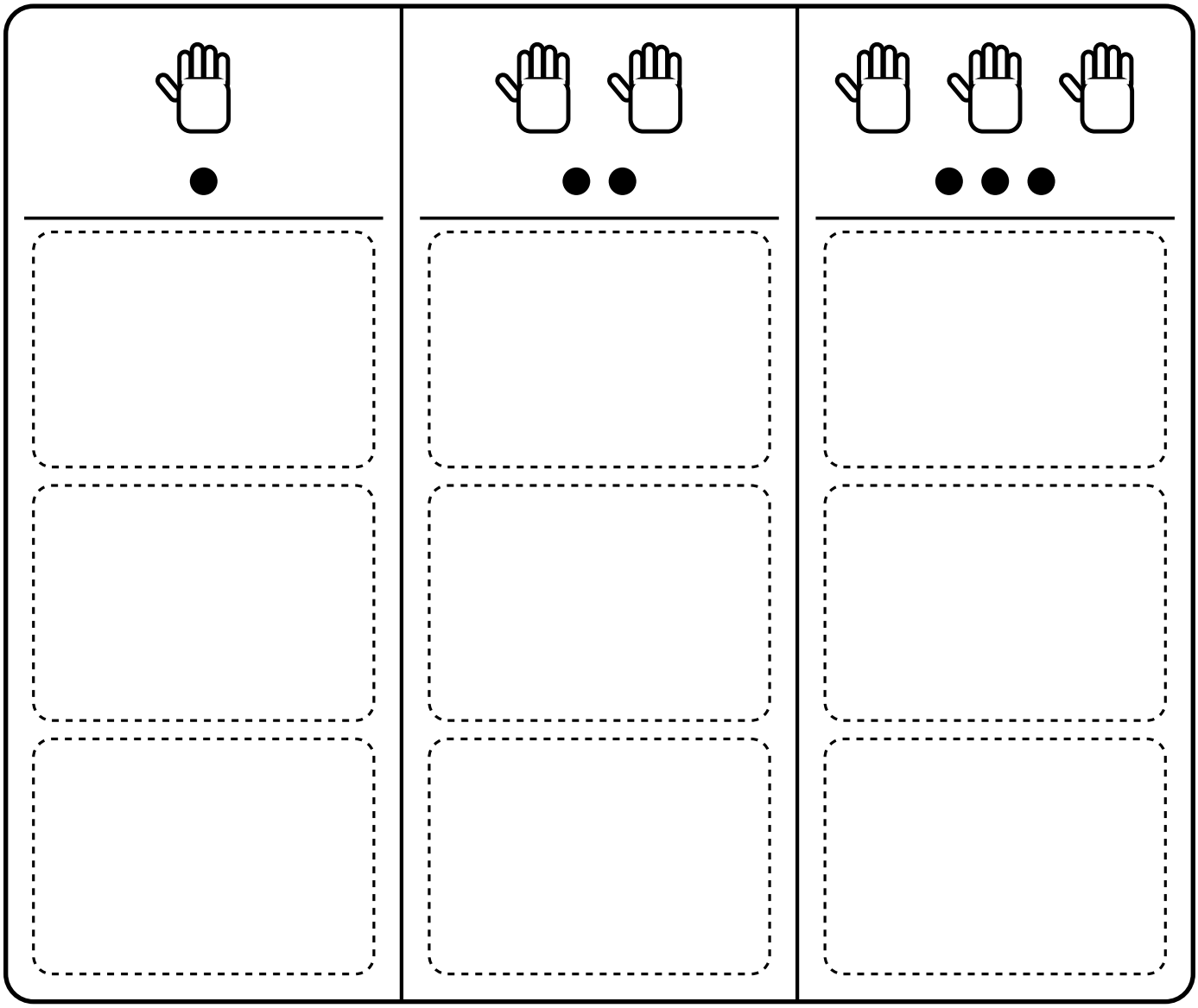
Clap the syllables

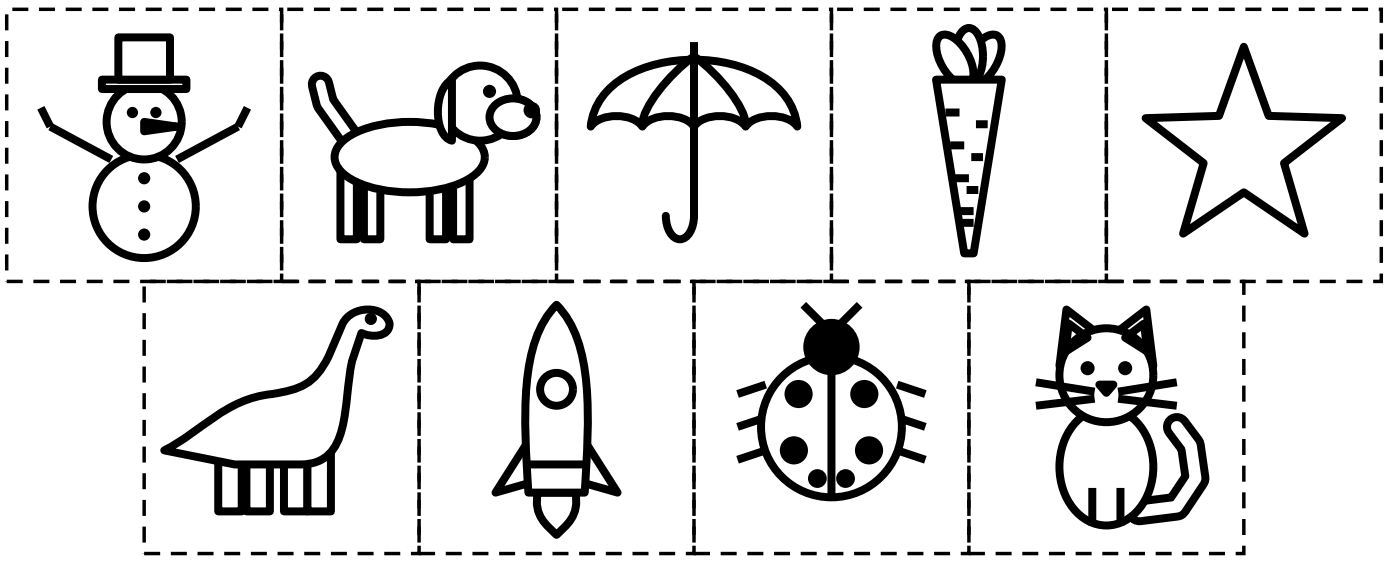
Grown-up: say each word slowly and clap the beats together. Your child colours one circle for each clap. Some words have 1 beat, some have 2, 3 or 4.



Clap and sort

Grown-up: cut out the nine pictures at the bottom. Say each word and clap it. Your child puts it under the hands that match the number of claps.





Answers and picture names

Rhyme match (page 3)

Left, top to bottom: cat, frog, box, bee, car, snail.
Right, top to bottom: dog, tree, hat, whale, fox, star.
Pairs: cat – hat, dog – frog, fox – box, bee – tree, star – car, snail – whale.

Odd one out (page 4)

Row 1: snake, sun, cake. Circle: sun.
Row 2: ball, mouse, house. Circle: ball.
Row 3: moon, spoon, fish. Circle: fish.
Row 4: sock, bus, clock. Circle: bus.
Row 5: key, bell, shell. Circle: key.

Rhyme cards (page 5)

Cards, row by row: cake, clock, house, spoon, star, bell,
sock, moon, snake, car, mouse, shell.
Pairs: cake – snake, mouse – house, moon – spoon, sock – clock, bell – shell, star – car.

Clap the syllables (page 6), row by row

sun = 1 butterfly (but-ter-fly) = 3 apple (ap-ple) = 2
watermelon (wa-ter-mel-on) = 4 banana (ba-na-na) = 3 ball = 1
caterpillar (cat-er-pil-lar) = 4 spider (spi-der) = 2 elephant (el-e-phant) = 3
fish = 1 helicopter (hel-i-cop-ter) = 4 rainbow (rain-bow) = 2

Clap and sort (page 7)

Cards, row by row: snowman, dog, umbrella, carrot, star, dinosaur, rocket, ladybird, cat.
1 clap: dog, star, cat.
2 claps: snowman (snow-man), carrot (car-rot), rocket (rock-et).
3 claps: umbrella (um-brel-la), dinosaur (di-no-saur), ladybird (la-dy-bird).